

WHAT SHOULD I OPEN?

South has a typical opening hand (12-21 HCP). The challenge: pick the right opening bid.

Decision tree:

- 20-21 HCP balanced (any 4333, 4432, or 5332 with 5-card minor) open 2NT
- 15-17 HCP balanced open 1NT
- Open the longest five-card or longer suit at the one-level. If you have two suits that

are the same length, open the higher ranking.

- Open 1♦ if you have four diamonds and four or fewer clubs.
- Open 1♦ if your shape is exactly 4=4=3=2.
- Otherwise, Open 1♣.

<https://pfdubois.github.io/BridgeBidding/Opening.html#choosing-a-n-opening-bid>

4NT: Blackwood, asking for aces -- 5♣ = 0 or 4, 5♦ = 1, 5♥ = 2, 5♠ = 3; 5NT then asks for kings the same way. Quantitative (inviting 6NT) after a natural notrump bid.